DEVELPOD BY ESEKE WYCLIFE

FOR HISTORY 1

Item 1

The United States of America began as thirteen British colonies along the Atlantic coast. In 1776, the colonists declared independence from Britain, citing grievances over taxation without representation, trade restrictions and lack of political voice. After a long and costly war, they won their freedom in 1783. Over the next two centuries, the United States expanded from a fragile confederation of small states into the most powerful country in the world, driven by territorial expansion, industrialisation, immigration and strong federal institutions. However, this growth was also marked by internal divisions, including slavery and civil war, which tested the nation's unity and identity.

In Boko Town, youth groups have started forming organisations based on strong ethnic and regional identity. Some believe that strong group identity promotes unity and local interests. Others fear that these divisions may create mistrust among people and weaken public unity. These concerns have created debate within the town. The Town Council has invited residents to share ideas on how to promote peace and unity. You have been asked by your area chairperson to present how a nation can achieve independence and build unity, or create instability if poorly managed, using lessons from the American experience of nation-building.

Task:

(a) Analyse the factors that led to the emergence of the United States of America as an independent nation.

(b) Evaluate the lessons African countries can learn from the American experience of nation-building to address the divisions in the scenario.

Item 2

In the late 18th and early 19th centuries, freed slaves from Britain and America were resettled in West Africa. Britain founded Sierra Leone in 1792, and America founded Liberia in 1822, with the aim of providing freed slaves a home where they could enjoy freedom and rebuild their lives. However, the settlers frequently came into conflict with local African populations over land, trade and political authority. In Liberia, the Americo-Liberian minority ruled over the majority until a brutal civil war erupted in 1990. A Liberian elder observed: "The slaves were freed, but they became the oppressors." This experience raised questions about identity, belonging and the relationship between settlers and indigenous communities.

Task:

(a) Examine the factors that led to the founding of states mentioned in the scenario.

(b) Respond to the Liberian elder, explaining why the freed slaves might have developed a sense of superiority over the indigenous Africans.